

The saints that resurrected after Jesus

In only one of the synoptic gospels do we read about a very curious recount of many saints who resurrected after Jesus and left their graves and went into Jerusalem and many people saw them. A scant 27 words comprise the description of this miraculous event and we're *seemingly* left wondering a plethora of questions such as:

- What did they do in the city? How long were they there?
- Where were they before they resurrected?
- Why did they resurrect after Jesus and not instead after his crucifixion and before his resurrection?

Some of the questions that we might have are answered in the Bible and many of them remain secret ([Deu 29:29](#)). You are invited to join me for this challenging and enlightening Bible study which has been ongoing for at least two years to discover what we can learn from the Bible about this miraculous event. For brevity, most verse contexts have been omitted and you will be required to get into your Bible and pray nearly every step of *the way* ([Act 17:11](#), [2Ti 2:15](#)).

The bridegroom

Matthew 27:50-53

⁵⁰ Jesus, when he had cried again with a loud voice, yielded up the ghost.

⁵¹ And, behold, the veil of the temple was rent in twain from the top to the bottom; and the earth did quake, and the rocks rent;

⁵² And the graves were opened; and many bodies of the saints which slept arose,

⁵³ And came out of the graves **after his resurrection**, and went into the holy city, and appeared unto many.

- After Jesus' resurrection **many** saints were **resurrected** and went into Jerusalem.
 - [Nehemiah 11:1,18](#), [Isaiah 52:1](#), [Daniel 9:24](#), [Matthew 4:5](#)

The bride

Psalms 30:4

Sing unto the LORD, O ye saints of his, and give thanks at the remembrance of his holiness.

Psalms 97:10

Ye that love the LORD, hate evil: he preserveth the souls of his saints; he delivereth them out of the hand of the wicked.

1 Samuel 2:9

He will keep the feet of his saints, and the wicked shall be silent in darkness; for by strength shall no man prevail.

Acts 9:13 (Ananias responding to the Lord about Saul/Paul)

Then Ananias answered, Lord, I have heard by many of this man, how much evil he hath done to thy saints at Jerusalem:

Philippians 4:21

Salute every saint in Christ Jesus. The brethren which are with me greet you.

Jude 1:14

And Enoch also, the seventh from Adam, prophesied of these, saying, Behold, the Lord cometh with ten thousands of his saints,

- Saints are washed by the blood; saved from the wrath to come; the reborn; the children, sons, brethren, friends and servants of God; heirs of the righteousness which is by faith; heirs of salvation and of the promise; heirs of God and joint-heirs with Christ.

Sleep

John 11:11-14

¹¹ These things said he: and after that he saith unto them, **Our friend Lazarus sleepeth; but I go, that I may awake him out of sleep.**

¹² Then said his disciples, Lord, if he sleep, he shall do well.

¹³ Howbeit Jesus spake of his death: but they thought that he had spoken of taking of rest in sleep.

¹⁴ Then said Jesus unto them plainly, **Lazarus is dead.**

Sleep as in the body is dead (Ecc 12:7)

Deuteronomy 31:16

And the LORD said unto Moses, **Behold, thou shalt sleep with thy fathers; and this people will rise up, and go a whoring after the gods of the strangers of the land, whither they go to be among them, and will forsake me, and break my covenant which I have made with them.**

Genesis 2:21

And the LORD God caused a deep sleep to fall upon Adam, and he slept: and he took one of his ribs, and closed up the flesh instead thereof;

Genesis 28:16

And Jacob awaked out of his sleep, and he said, Surely the LORD is in this place; and I knew it not.

Matthew 1:20-24

²⁰ But while he thought on these things, behold, the angel of the Lord appeared unto him in a dream, saying, **Joseph, thou son of David, fear not to take unto thee Mary thy wife: for that which is conceived in her is of the Holy Ghost.**

²¹ **And she shall bring forth a son, and thou shalt call his name JESUS: for he shall save his people from their sins.**

²² Now all this was done, that it might be fulfilled which was spoken of the Lord by the prophet, saying,

²³ Behold, a virgin shall be with child, and shall bring forth a son, and they shall call his name Emmanuel, which being interpreted is, God with us.

²⁴ Then Joseph being raised from sleep did as the angel of the Lord had bidden him, and took unto him his wife:

Sleep as in to rest

Romans 13:11

And that, knowing the time, that now it is high time to awake out of sleep: for now is our salvation nearer than when we believed.

Sleep as in living carelessly with regards to spiritual matters

1 Thessalonians 5:6

Therefore let us not sleep, as do others; but let us watch and be sober.

Hell

Revelation 20:13,14

¹³ And the sea gave up the dead which were in it; and death and hell^{G86} delivered up the dead which were in them: and they were judged every man according to their works.

¹⁴ And death and hell^{G86} were cast into the lake of fire. This is the second death.

- And so we learn that hell is not the final destination for any of the dead.

Genesis 37:35 (Jacob speaking) And all his sons and all his daughters rose up to comfort him; but he refused to be comforted; and he said, For I will go down into the grave^{H7585} unto my son mourning. Thus his father wept for him. Numbers 16:30 (Moses speaking about the sons of Korah) But if the LORD make a new thing, and the earth open her mouth, and swallow them up, with all that <i>appertain</i> unto them, and they go down quick into the pit^{H7585}; then ye shall understand that these men have provoked the LORD. Deuteronomy 32:22 (the song of Moses) For a fire is kindled in mine anger, and shall burn unto the lowest hell^{H7585}, and shall consume the earth with her increase, and set on fire the foundations of the mountains.	H7585 שְׁאוֹל (sh'ôwl sheh-ole') Derivation: from H7592 Strong's: Hades or the world of the dead (as if a subterranean retreat), including its accessories and inmates. KJV usage: grave, hell, pit
Daniel 12:2 And many of them that sleep in the dust of the earth shall awake, some to everlasting life, and some to shame and everlasting contempt^{H1860}. Isaiah 66:24 And they shall go forth, and look upon the carcases of the men that have transgressed against me: for their worm shall not die, neither shall their fire be quenched; and they shall be an abhorring^{H1860} unto all flesh.	There doesn't appear to be a <i>single</i> Hebrew word in the old testament referring to the final destination of those separated from God (which would be the OT equivalent to G1067).
Matthew 11:23 And thou, Capernaum, which art exalted unto heaven, shalt be brought down to hell^{G86}: for if the mighty works, which have been done in thee, had been done in Sodom, it would have remained until this day. 1 Corinthians 15:55 (cross ref. Isaiah 25:8) O death, where is thy sting? O grave^{G86}, where is thy victory?	G86 ἄδης (háidēs hah'-dace) Derivation: from G1 (as negative particle) and G1492 Strong's: properly, unseen, i.e. "Hades" or the place (state) of departed souls KJV usage: grave, hell
Matthew 5:22 But I say unto you, That whosoever is angry with his brother without a cause shall be in danger of the judgment: and whosoever shall say to his brother, Raca, shall be in danger of the council: but whosoever shall say, Thou fool, shall be in danger of hell^{G1067} fire. Matthew 10:28 And fear not them which kill the body, but are not able to kill the soul: but rather fear him which is able to destroy both soul and body in hell^{G1067}. Mark 9:45 And if thy foot offend thee, cut it off: it is better for thee to enter halt into life, than having two feet to be cast into hell^{G1067}, into the fire that never shall be quenched: Revelation 20:14 ¹⁴ And death and hell^{G86} were cast into the lake of fire. This is the second death.	G1067 γέεννα (géenna gheh'-en-nah) Derivation: of Hebrew origin (H1516 and H2011); Strong's: valley of (the son of) Hinnom; ge-henna (or Ge-Hinnom), a valley of Jerusalem, used (figuratively) as a name for the place (or state) of everlasting punishment KJV usage: hell

- And so we learn that Hades and Gehenna are not the same place and that we need to be very careful when we see the word hell.

Other names/phrases for hell

Ezekiel 31:12-18

¹⁰ Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Because thou hast lifted up thyself in height, and he hath shot up his top among the thick boughs, and his heart is lifted up in his height;

¹¹ I have therefore delivered him into the hand of the mighty one of the heathen; he shall surely deal with him: I have driven him out for his wickedness.

¹² And strangers, the terrible of the nations, have cut him off, and have left him: upon the mountains and in all the valleys his branches are fallen, and his boughs are broken by all the rivers of the land; and all the people of the earth are gone down from his shadow, and have left him.

¹³ Upon his ruin shall all the fowls of the heaven remain, and all the beasts of the field shall be upon his branches:

¹⁴ To the end that none of all the trees by the waters exalt themselves for their height, neither shoot up their top among the thick boughs, neither their trees stand up in their height, all that drink water^{Pro 16:18}: for they are all delivered unto death, to the **nether parts of the earth**, in the midst of the children of men, with them that go down to **the pit**.

¹⁵ Thus saith the Lord GOD; In the day when he went down to **the grave** I caused a mourning: I covered **the deep** for him, and I restrained the floods thereof, and the great waters were stayed: and I caused Lebanon to mourn for him, and all the trees of the field fainted for him.

¹⁶ I made the nations to shake at the sound of his fall, when I cast him down **to hell** with them that descend into **the pit**: and all the trees of Eden, the choice and best of Lebanon, all that drink water, shall be comforted in the **nether parts of the earth**.

¹⁷ They also went down into **hell** with him unto *them that be slain with the sword*; and *they that were his arm, that dwelt under his shadow in the midst of the heathen*.

¹⁸ To whom art thou thus like in glory and in greatness among the trees of Eden? yet shalt thou be brought down with the trees of Eden unto the **nether parts of the earth**: thou shalt lie in the midst of the uncircumcised with *them that be slain by the sword*. This is Pharaoh and all his multitude, saith the Lord GOD.

- Much like Jotham's parable in **Judges 9:7-15** people are represented as trees.
- In **Ezekiel 31**, the prophet Ezekiel is sent to warn the Pharaoh of Egypt that him and all his multitude's fate would be the same as the Assyrians. Both the Pharaoh and the Assyrian had exalted themselves up after being given great wealth and power by God.
- In **v14** God tells us the purpose for verses **10-13**: and that is to serve as a warning to all other prosperous people to not exalt themselves.
 - **Deuteronomy 8:18, Romans 11:18-21, 1 Timothy 6:17**

NOTE: "the deep" is also a phrase that is used to refer to the depths of a body of water (literally and/or figuratively).

Numbers 16:30

But if the LORD make a new thing, and the earth open her mouth, and swallow them up, with all that appertain unto them, and they go down quick **into the pit**^{H7585}; then ye shall understand that these men have provoked the LORD.

Luke 8:31

And they besought him that he would not command them to go out into **the deep**^{G12}.

Romans 10:7

Or, Who shall descend into **the deep**^{G12}? (that is, to bring up Christ again from **the dead**.)

Revelation 9:1

And the fifth angel sounded, and I saw a star fall from heaven unto the earth: and to him was given the key **of the bottomless**^{G12} pit.

Revelation 20:1

And I saw an angel come down from heaven, having the key of **the bottomless pit**^{G12} and a great chain in his hand.

Ezekiel 32:18,24 "nether parts of the earth" & "the pit"

The divisions of hell, the temporary abode of the dead

Luke 16:23-26

²³ And in hell^{G86} he lift up his eyes, being in torments, and seeth Abraham afar off, and Lazarus in his bosom.

²⁴ And he cried and said, Father Abraham, have mercy on me, and send Lazarus, that he may dip the tip of his finger in water, and cool my tongue; for I am tormented in this flame.

²⁵ But Abraham said, Son, remember that thou in thy lifetime receivedst thy good things, and likewise Lazarus evil things: but now he is comforted, and thou art tormented.

²⁶ And beside all this, between us and you there is a great gulf fixed: so that they which would pass from hence to you cannot; neither can they pass to us, that *would come* from thence.

- Note that this is not a parable. God is explicit every time that He spoke in parables for example [Luke 5:36](#), [6:39](#), [8:4,9,11](#), [12:16,41](#), [13:6](#), [14:7](#), [15:3](#), [18:1,9](#), [19:11](#), [20:9,19](#), and [21:29](#).
 - The last parable before the recounting of the rich man and Lazarus is at [Luke 15:3-10](#). From thereafter He does not speak another parable until [Luke 18](#).
- Abraham, Lazarus, and the rich man all went to the same general place after they physically died (hell).
- The rich man, Lazarus, and Abraham were all close enough to see and to speak to each other.
- From these verses we learn that hell has at least two separate places within it: the place of torment (where the rich man is) and the place of comfort (where Abraham and Lazarus were).

Defining terminology

Deuteronomy 24:6

No man shall take the nether^{H7347} or the upper millstone to pledge: for he taketh a man's life to pledge.

Joshua 15:19

Who answered, Give me a blessing; for thou hast given me a south land; give me also springs of water. And he gave her the upper springs, and the nether^{H8482} springs.

Lamentations 3:55

I called upon thy name, O LORD, out of the low^{H8482} dungeon.

Genesis 6:16

A window shalt thou make to the ark, and in a cubit shalt thou finish it above; and the door of the ark shalt thou set in the side thereof; with lower^{H8482}, second, and third stories shalt thou make it.

Deuteronomy 32:22

For a fire is kindled in mine anger, and shall burn unto the lowest^{H8482} hell, and shall consume the earth with her increase, and set on fire the foundations of the mountains.

- “nether” has three Strong’s numbers associated with it: H8481, H8482, & H7347.
- A general definition of the word “nether” as it is used in the Bible is “low/lower/lowest”.
- This definition may seem trivial at first but as we can see in at least [Ephesians 4:9](#) it is a bridge between the old and the new testament concerning prophecy.

That thou mayest say to the prisoners, Go forth

Psalms 68:18

Thou hast ascended on high, thou hast led captivity captive: thou hast received gifts for men; yea, for the rebellious also, that the LORD God might dwell among them.

Ephesians 4:8-10

⁸ Wherefore he saith, When he ascended up on high, he led captivity captive, and gave gifts unto men.

⁹ (Now that he ascended, what is it but that he also descended first into the lower parts of the earth?

¹⁰ He that descended is the same also that ascended up far above all heavens, that he might fill all things.)

- 1 "low* part* of the earth" is a phrase that in 4 out of 5 instances refers to the temporary abode of the dead.
 - Psalm 63:9,10, Isaiah 44:22,23, Ephesians 4:9, and Ezekiel 26:20 (H8482, G2737).
 - Curiously, the phrase "lowest parts"^{H8482} of the earth" in Psalm 139:15 refers figuratively to "the womb".
- 2 In it's literal sense, it is equivalent to the phrase "nether/lower parts of the earth".
- 3 But, what is this phrase that He "*led captivity captive*"?
 - Who was captive, where were they, and where did Jesus take them?

Them that were bound

Job 3:17-19

¹⁷ There the wicked cease from troubling; and there the weary be at rest.

¹⁸ There the prisoners^{H615} rest together; they hear not the voice of the oppressor.

¹⁹ The small and great are there; and the servant is free from his master.

- When Job lamented the day of his birth and longed for death, he referred to the dead as "prisoners".
- Why did the Holy Ghost call the dead prisoners?

Which prison?

Isaiah 14:17

That made the world as a wilderness, and destroyed the cities thereof; that opened not the house of his prisoners?

Isaiah 42:7

⁷ To open the blind eyes, to bring out the prisoners from the prison, and them that sit in darkness out of the prison house.

Isaiah 49:9

That thou mayest say to the prisoners, Go forth; to them that are in darkness, Shew yourselves. They shall feed in the ways, and their pastures shall be in all high places.

Zechariah 9:11-12

¹¹ As for thee also, by the blood of thy covenant I have sent forth thy prisoners out of the pit wherein is no water.

¹² Turn you to the strong hold, ye prisoners of hope: even to day do I declare that I will render double unto thee;

Isaiah 24:21

And they shall be gathered together, as prisoners are gathered in the pit, and shall be shut up in the prison, and after many days shall they be visited.

- There are many other verses about spiritual prisoners and we will look at some of them closer later on.
- Note that "prisoners" is used not only to refer to those trapped by their own sin and those waiting in hell but also a prisoner in the physical sense which we are most familiar with.

Whom shall I send?

Hosea 13:14

I will ransom them from the power of the grave; I will redeem them from death: O death, I will be thy plagues; O grave, I will be thy destruction: repentance shall be hid from mine eyes.

- Among judgments against Israel, Ephraim, and Samaria we can see a prophecy that the LORD God Himself will (future tense) *ransom* them from the *power* of the grave. He will (future tense) *redeem* them from *death*.
- The grave having power over the dead makes them prisoners.

Hosea 6:2

After two days will he revive us: in the third day he will raise us up, and we shall live in his sight.

- Again in **Hosea**, we see a very specific, *seemingly* out of place prophecy to a plurality of people being resurrected on which day? The third day (**John 2:19**).
- Where else, in the entire Bible, can we apply this prophecy besides **Matthew 27:52,53**?

Psalms 49:15

But God will redeem my soul from the power of the grave^{H7585}: for he shall receive me. Selah.

- Yet another reference to the power that the grave *had* over souls and of one being *bought back* from that.
- Note that H7585 is the Hebrew word “Sheol” (English: *pit, hell*), the temporary abode of the dead.

Who will go for us?

Psalms 69:13-15 (God the Son speaking to God the Father through God the Holy Ghost by the hand of the sweet psalmist of Israel)

¹³ But as for me, my prayer is unto thee, O LORD, in an acceptable time: O God, in the multitude of thy mercy hear me, in the truth of thy salvation.

¹⁴ Deliver me out of the mire, and let me not sink: let me be delivered from them that hate me, and out of the deep waters.

¹⁵ Let not the waterflood overflow me, neither let the deep swallow me up, and let not the pit shut her mouth upon me.

Isaiah 49:8,9 (God the Father's response)

⁸ Thus saith the LORD, In an acceptable time have I heard thee, and in a day of salvation have I helped thee: and I will preserve thee, and give thee for a covenant of the people, to establish the earth, to cause to inherit the desolate heritages;

⁹ That thou mayest say to the prisoners, Go forth; to them that are in darkness, Shew yourselves. They shall feed in the ways, and their pastures shall be in all high places.

Acts 2:24

Whom God hath raised up, having loosed the pains of death: because it was not possible that he should be holden of it.

- Those in hell would be kept there until the acceptable time (**1 John 2:2**).
 - When would that acceptable time be?
- Jesus' prayer in **Psa 69** was written roughly 1,000 years in advance and God the Father gave Him more than He asked for (**Eph 3:20,21**).

Transfer of authority

Revelation 1:18

I am he that liveth, and was dead; and, behold, I am alive for evermore, Amen; and have the keys of hell^{G86} and of death.

Matthew 28:18

And Jesus came and spake unto them, saying, All power is given unto me in heaven and in earth.

- Why did Jesus tell us this only *after* His resurrection?
- In order for that authority to be transferred the proper atoning sacrifice had to be made after which God the Father was satisfied and then the keys (authority) over the gates of hell and of death was transferred to Jesus whereupon He became the author of eternal salvation (**Hebrews 5:9**).

Who had the power of death before Jesus?

Hebrews 2:14

Forasmuch then as the children are partakers of flesh and blood, he also himself likewise took part of the same; that through death he might destroy him that had the power of death, that is, the devil;

1 John 3:8

He that committeth sin is of the devil; for the devil sinneth from the beginning. For this purpose the Son of God was manifested, that he might destroy the works of the devil.

1 Corinthians 15:26

The last enemy that shall be destroyed is death.

The scales of Justice are no longer wanting

Isaiah 53:11

He shall see of the travail of his soul, and shall be satisfied: by his knowledge shall my righteous servant justify many; for he shall bear their iniquities.

God the Father shall see of the travail of Jesus' soul, and God the Father shall be satisfied: by Jesus' knowledge shall God the Father's righteous servant Jesus justify many; for Jesus shall bear their iniquities.

- After suffering a multitude of injustice and then His victory on the cross (**John 19:30**), God the Father could then transfer all authority to Jesus (**Mat 28:18**) and eventually Jesus will give it back (**1 Corinthians 15:22-28**).

Everything changes

Luke 24:49

And, behold, I send the promise of my Father upon you: but tarry ye in the city of Jerusalem, until ye be endued with power from on high.

Acts 1:4, 2:16-21, Joel 2:28-32

- That Spirit that God poured out (**Acts 2:41, 4:4, 19:18,19, 21:20**) and that power from on high is the Holy Ghost and his ministry and that prophecy continues today.
- Notice that only part of the prophecy in **Joel** has been fulfilled so far.

Another prophecy from Jesus connected to Hosea 13:14

Matthew 16:18		Tense, voice, mood
And I say also unto thee, That thou art Peter, and upon this rock I will build my church; and the gates of hell ^{G86} shall not prevail against it.	I say	Present, active, indicative
	art	Present, indicative
	I will build	Future, active, indicative
	prevail against	Future, active, indicative

- When Jesus said “this rock” He was referring to what Simon Peter had just said in v16 “Thou art the Christ, the Son of the living God”.
 - “this rock” is none other than the Rock of Moses (Deu 32:4), the rock of David (Psa 18:31, 46), of Israel (Psa 78:35), the rock of offense to the disobedient that reject the chief corner stone (Isa 8:14, Rom 9:33, 1Pe 2:8), and the Rock that followed Israel through the wilderness (1Co 10:4).
- Why would Jesus mention specifically that the gates of hell would not prevail against His church?
 - He didn’t mention hell because of that being where the throne/stronghold of Satan is, like the world would have you believe, because he isn’t there (1Pe 5:8, Rev 12:12).
 - He mentioned the gates of hell because something was there that belonged to Him and He would rescue them from hell just like God the Father rescued Jesus from hell.

What was Jesus talking about here?

John 5:25-29

²⁵ Verily, verily, I say unto you, The hour is coming, and now is, when the dead shall hear the voice of the Son of God: and they that hear shall live.

²⁶ For as the Father hath life in himself; so hath he given to the Son to have life in himself;

²⁷ And hath given him authority to execute judgment also, because he is the Son of man.

²⁸ Marvel not at this: for the hour is coming, in the which all that are in the graves shall hear his voice,

²⁹ And shall come forth; they that have done good, unto the resurrection of life; and they that have done evil, unto the resurrection of damnation.

- Notice in v25 how “The hour is coming, and now is” is both present tense and future tense at the same time? That’s not an accident of transcription or an error in grammar. Jesus knew exactly what He was saying and why.
 - The dead (in their sins) were hearing the voice of the Son of God as He spoke these words and many more in the present tense.
 - And, in the future the dead in hell would also hear the voice of the Son of God.

Both the living and the dead hear the voice of the Saviour

1 Peter 3:18-20

¹⁸ For Christ also hath once suffered for sins, the just for the unjust, that he might bring us to God, being put to death in the flesh, but quickened by the Spirit:

¹⁹ By which also he went and preached unto the spirits in prison;

²⁰ Which sometime were disobedient, when once the longsuffering of God waited in the days of Noah, while the ark was a preparing, wherein few, that is, eight souls were saved by water.

- If the dead were already with God why would they need to be brought to God?
- Notice that we are not told that Jesus only preached to one side or the other of hell, or to the upper or lowest part of hell. It appears that from what we are told that Jesus preached to everyone in hell.

Psalms 16:10

For thou wilt not leave my soul in hell; neither wilt thou suffer thine Holy One to see corruption.

Acts 2:25-27,31

²⁵ For David speaketh concerning him, I foresaw the Lord always before my face, for he is on my right hand, that I should not be moved:

²⁶ Therefore did my heart rejoice, and my tongue was glad; moreover also my flesh shall rest in hope:

²⁷ Because thou wilt not leave my soul in hell, neither wilt thou suffer thine Holy One to see corruption.

³¹ He seeing this before spake of the resurrection of Christ, that his soul was not left in hell, neither his flesh did see corruption.

- Peter's first sermon in Acts 2 reveals to us who David was writing about in Psalm 16:10.
 - Not coincidentally, what David said as he was moved by the Holy Ghost was also truth concerning his own soul which would wait in the comfort side of hell for over 1,000 years.
- In order for Jesus' soul to not be left in hell: it would first have to go there.

Samuel is brought "up" after his death

1 Samuel 28:11-15

¹¹ Then said the woman, Whom shall I bring up unto thee? And he said, Bring me up Samuel.

¹² And when the woman saw Samuel, she cried with a loud voice: and the woman spake to Saul, saying, Why hast thou deceived me? for thou art Saul.

¹³ And the king said unto her, Be not afraid: for what sawest thou? And the woman said unto Saul, I saw gods ascending out of the earth.

¹⁴ And he said unto her, What form is he of? And she said, An old man cometh up; and he is covered with a mantle. And Saul perceived that it was Samuel, and he stooped with his face to the ground, and bowed himself.

¹⁵ And Samuel said to Saul, Why hast thou disquieted me, to bring me up? And Saul answered, I am sore distressed; for the Philistines make war against me, and God is departed from me, and answereth me no more, neither by prophets, nor by dreams: therefore I have called thee, that thou mayest make known unto me what I shall do.

1 Samuel 28:19

Moreover the LORD will also deliver Israel with thee into the hand of the Philistines: and to morrow shalt thou and thy sons be with me: the LORD also shall deliver the host of Israel into the hand of the Philistines.

- The witch of Endor brought Samuel "up" from the nether parts of the earth and not "down" from heaven.
- The spirits that the woman saw were "ascending out of the earth".
- Whether you believe Saul and his sons were saved or not, Samuel says "thou and thy sons [will] be with me [tomorrow]".
 - He was not only saying that they were going to die but also that they would be in the same place as Samuel.

This Psalm takes on a whole new meaning

Psalms 18:0,4-24

¶ (To the chief Musician, A Psalm of David, the servant of the LORD, who spake unto the LORD the words of this song in the day that the LORD delivered him from the hand of all his enemies, and from the hand of Saul): And he said,

...

⁴ The sorrows of death compassed me, and the floods of ungodly men made me afraid.

⁵ The sorrows of hell compassed me about: the snares of death prevented me.

⁶ In my distress I called upon the LORD, and cried unto my God: he heard my voice out of his temple, and my cry came before him, even into his ears.

⁷ Then the earth shook and trembled; the foundations also of the hills moved and were shaken, because he was wroth.

⁸ There went up a smoke out of his nostrils, and fire out of his mouth devoured: coals were kindled by it.

⁹ He bowed the heavens also, and came down: and darkness was under his feet.

¹⁰ And he rode upon a cherub, and did fly: yea, he did fly upon the wings of the wind.

¹¹ He made darkness his secret place; his pavilion round about him were dark waters and thick clouds of the skies.

¹² At the brightness that was before him his thick clouds passed, hail stones and coals of fire.

¹³ The LORD also thundered in the heavens, and the Highest gave his voice; hail stones and coals of fire.

¹⁴ Yea, he sent out his arrows, and scattered them; and he shot out lightnings, and discomfited them.

¹⁵ Then the channels of waters were seen, and the foundations of the world were discovered at thy rebuke, O LORD, at the blast of the breath of thy nostrils.

¹⁶ He sent from above, he took me, he drew me out of many waters.

¹⁷ He delivered me from my strong enemy, and from them which hated me: for they were too strong for me.

¹⁸ They prevented me in the day of my calamity: but the LORD was my stay.

¹⁹ He brought me forth also into a large place; he delivered me, because he delighted in me^{H2654 (Mat 3:17, 17:5, Mar 1:11, 2Pe 1:17)}.

²⁰ The LORD rewarded me according to my righteousness; according to the cleanness of my hands hath he recompensed me.

²¹ For I have kept the ways of the LORD, and have not wickedly departed from my God.

²² For all his judgments were before me, and I did not put away his statutes from me.

²³ I was also upright before him, and I kept myself from mine iniquity.

²⁴ Therefore hath the LORD recompensed me according to my righteousness, according to the cleanness of my hands in his eyesight.

- Nowhere is it recorded that David was delivered from death by God during which an earthquake occurred.
 - There was an earthquake after Jesus gave up the ghost ([Matthew 27:51](#)).
- v19 - In five different verses God the Father said He was "well pleased" (delighted) in His Son: [Matthew 3:17](#), [17:5](#), [Mark 1:11](#), [Luke 3:22](#), [2 Peter 1:17](#).
- Verses 20,24 with [Isaiah 64:6](#) and [Romans 3:23](#), we can only conclude that most if not all of these events are not about David but are instead prophecy about Jesus.
 - David very clearly departed from God when he committed adultery with Bathsheba and in his pride when he numbered the people and surely like all humans, reborn or not, he sinned on a regular basis.
 - [Proverbs 4:16](#), [26:11](#), [Psalms 51:3](#), [1 John 1:8](#)
- And so what we really have here is a very detailed description of God the Father saving God the Son that begins after Jesus' death on the cross...in the day that the LORD delivered Him from the hand of all His enemies.

A pivotal definition

Some have written or surmised (myself included) that paradise is the comfort side of hell but I believe that the Bible teaches us otherwise. The word “paradise” appears three times ([Luke 23:43](#), [2 Corinthians 12:4](#), [Revelation 2:7](#)).

Luke 23:43

And Jesus said unto him, **Verily I say unto thee, To day^{G4594} shalt thou be with me in paradise^{G3857}.**

- To the penitent thief on the cross beside Jesus it was promised that that day he would be in “paradise” with Jesus.
 - When He said “to day” He very specifically meant “this day” (the evening and the morning): not a day as in the unspecified sense such as in [Joel 2:31](#), the continual (daily) sense such as in [Exodus 13:21](#), the monthly (new moon) sense as in [Genesis 8:5](#), or the dawn (first light in the morning) as in [Genesis 32:24](#).
- Since Jesus descended into the lower parts of the earth where all the dead previously went, it makes sense that some might equate the comfort side of hell to paradise *if* you isolate this verse by itself. However, if you think about the implications of that it really makes no sense. For example: Those that were in the comfort side of hell were *brought to* God. A ransom was paid and they were bought *back*. If the comfort side of hell was equivalent to paradise then God would have already been there and there would be no need to *bring them* to God (or for God to go to them). Therefore, the hypothesis that paradise = the comfort side of hell is self-defeating.

2 Corinthians 12:1-4

¹ It is not expedient for me doubtless to glory. I will come to visions and revelations of the Lord.

² I knew a man in Christ above fourteen years ago, (whether in the body, I cannot tell; or whether out of the body, I cannot tell: God knoweth;) such an one **caught up to the third heaven**.

³ And I knew such a man, (whether in the body, or out of the body, I cannot tell: God knoweth;)

⁴ How that he was **caught up into paradise^{G3857}**, and heard unspeakable words, which it is not lawful for a man to utter.

⁵ Of such an one will I glory: yet of myself I will not glory, but in mine infirmities.

- The same place is referred to by two different names: “paradise” and “the third heaven”.
- If paradise was the comfort side of hell we would expect to see hell^{G86} (or an equivalent word or phrase) here instead of “the third heaven”. Instead, we see a phrase that is not only new but also entirely unique (which also means that there is one definition for “the third heaven” and that is “paradise”).
- We are only to glory in the Lord ([Jeremiah 9:23,24](#), [1 Corinthians 1:31, 3:21](#), [2 Corinthians 10:17](#)) so then **v5a** refers to the Lord. Wherever this third heaven/paradise is, the Lord is also there.

Revelation 2:7

He that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith unto the churches; To him that overcometh will I give to eat of the tree of life, which is in the midst of the paradise^{G3857} of God.

Revelation 22:1-2

¹ And he shewed me a pure river of water of life, clear as crystal, proceeding out of the throne of God and of the Lamb.

² In the midst of the street of it, and on either side of the river, *was there* the tree of life, which bare twelve manner of fruits, and yielded her fruit every month: and the leaves of the tree were for the healing of the nations.

- The tree of life is in the middle of the garden planted by the LORD God in [Genesis 2:8,9](#). It is in the middle of the paradise of God in [Revelation 2:7](#). After the new heaven and new earth is created ([Revelation 21](#)) the tree of life is in the middle of and on both sides of the pure river of water of life. None of these appear to be anywhere near the comfort side of hell.

Another Biblical perspective of the “third heaven”

Genesis 1:1

In the beginning God created the heaven^{H8064} and the earth.

Deuteronomy 10:14

Behold, the heaven^{H8064} and the heaven^{H8064} of heavens^{H8064} is the LORD's thy God, the earth *also*, with all that therein is.

1 Kings 8:27

But will God indeed dwell on the earth? behold, the heaven^{H8064} and heaven^{H8064} of heavens^{H8064} cannot contain thee; how much less this house that I have builded?

Psalms 113:4

The LORD is high above all nations, *and* his glory above the heavens.

Ephesians 4:10

He that descended is the same also that ascended up far above all heavens, that he might fill all things.)

- Heaven = sky.
- Heaven of heavens = sky of skies
- Above the heavens = Far above all heavens = above the heaven and the heaven of heavens.
- So if heaven is the sky and the sky of skies is everything above the sky, what then might the third heaven be? There's nothing left except the abode of God.

Depart ye workers of iniquity

John 8:21

Then said Jesus again unto them, *I go my way, and ye shall seek me, and shall die in your sins: whither I go, ye cannot come.*

- We know that Jesus wasn't referring to the grave/death/hell here because that's where all the dead went before He unlocked the gates of hell.
- So, where is the one place that those who die in their sins (reject Jesus) cannot go? It's not with God and it's not on earth – it's in the lowest parts of the earth (the torment side of hell). In other words, they receive what they chose and that is to be separated from God which results in persistent, continual death.
- That also means that the torment side of hell is not empty and it will continue to fill until the great white throne judgment (**Proverbs 27:20, 30:15,16a**).

Inherit the kingdom prepared for you

John 13:36

³⁶ Simon Peter said unto him, Lord, whither goest thou? Jesus answered him, *Whither I go, thou canst not follow me now; but thou shalt follow me afterwards.*

- Why couldn't Peter follow Him? Because Peter wasn't going to die until *after* Jesus.
- “**afterwards**” – after what?
- Those who do not reject Jesus go to where He **is**.

Majesty in the heavens

John 7:33

Then said Jesus unto them, Yet a little while am I with you, and then I go unto him that sent me.

John 14:12

Verily, verily, I say unto you, He that believeth on me, the works that I do shall he do also; and greater works than these shall he do; because I go unto my Father.

John 14:28

Ye have heard how I said unto you, I go away, and come again unto you. If ye loved me, ye would rejoice, because I said, I go unto the Father: for my Father is greater than I.

John 16:10,15

Of righteousness, because I go to my Father, and ye see me no more;

John 16:16

A little while, and ye shall not see me: and again, a little while, and ye shall see me, because I go to the Father.

- 4 Verses that state plainly where Jesus went after He ascended to the Father: **Mark 16:19**, **Luke 22:69**, **Acts 7:55,56**, **Romans 8:34**, **Colossians 3:1**, **Hebrews 10:12**, **12:2**, **1 Peter 3:22**.

Not as simple as it may appear

John 20:17

Jesus saith unto her, Touch me not; for I am not yet ascended to my Father: but go to my brethren, and say unto them, I ascend unto my Father, and your Father; and to my God, and your God.

- 5 After Jesus' resurrection He tells Mary that He had not yet ascended to the Father. But, didn't we just learn from the definition of "paradise" that the penitent thief on the cross next to Jesus would be in paradise *with Jesus the day* that Jesus died on the cross?
- 6 There are *at least* two explanations:
- In **Luke 23:43** when Jesus' said "me" He meant God the Father (**1 John 5:7**) and God the Son did not ascend to paradise until later.
 - In this case, the angels of God might have escorted the dead in Christ to paradise or they just went themselves since Jesus unlocked the gates of hell and they had liberty to do so.
 - Here in **John 20:17** Jesus was referring simply to His *bodily* ascension (**Acts 1:9**).

Men & Women in heaven

Revelation 5:3

And no man^{G3762} in heaven, nor in earth, neither under the earth, was able to open the book, neither to look thereon.

Revelation 6:9

⁹ And when he had opened the fifth seal, I saw under the altar the souls of them that were slain for the word of God, and for the testimony which they held:

- In **Revelation** we now see that there are men and women in heaven with God.
- Notice also that there is a transition in general language from the old testament until Jesus' resurrection to after His resurrection in that how the dead in Christ are written of.
- Where in the old testament can we read about the dead in Christ being in heaven with God (not in the future tense)?

Upon white horses

1 Thessalonians 4:14-17

¹⁴ For if we believe that Jesus died and rose again, even so them also which sleep in Jesus will God bring with him.

- Those who die (sleep) in Jesus will be with Him when He returns.
 - Note that this (or any other verse) does not necessitate that they are *always* with Him until that happens.
- This (and other new testament verses) are in stark contrast to verses that took place in time before Jesus' resurrection such as **Genesis 37:35** where we see a Godly man (**Genesis 49:18**) speaking of going to hell.

Most deceptions are mingled with truth (**Isaiah 14:14b**)

2 Timothy 2:15-18

¹⁵ Study to shew thyself approved unto God, a workman that needeth not to be ashamed, rightly dividing the word of truth.

¹⁶ But shun profane and vain babblings: for they will increase unto more ungodliness.

¹⁷ And their word will eat as doth a canker: of whom is Hymenaeus and Philetus;

¹⁸ Who concerning the truth have erred, saying that the resurrection is past already; and overthrow the faith of some.

- What if Hymenaeus and Philetus used the resurrection of the saints that occurred after Jesus' to deceive some?
- It's not a far stretch that they may have pointed to that event (which was likely noised abroad quite quickly) as "proof" for their deception and that's how some people believed them.

No new thing under the sun

2 Thessalonians 2:1-3

¹ Now we beseech you, brethren, by the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ, and by our gathering together unto him,

² That ye be not soon shaken in mind, or be troubled, neither by spirit, nor by word, nor by letter as from us, as that the day of Christ is at hand.

³ Let no man deceive you by any means: for that day shall not come, except there come a falling away first, and that man of sin be revealed, the son of perdition;

- That same deception could have been some of the content of these false words and false letters which made their way all the way to Thessalonica.

Zechariah 9:9-11

⁹ Rejoice greatly, O daughter of Zion; shout, O daughter of Jerusalem: behold, thy King cometh unto thee: he is just, and having salvation; lowly, and riding upon an ass, and upon a colt the foal of an ass.

¹⁰ And I will cut off the chariot from Ephraim, and the horse from Jerusalem, and the battle bow shall be cut off: and he shall speak peace unto the heathen: and his dominion *shall be* from sea even to sea, and from the river even to the ends of the earth.

¹¹ As for thee also, by the blood of thy covenant I have sent forth ^{H8765 (H8840, H8816)} thy prisoners out of the pit wherein is no water.

- In the chapter beginning the messianic prophecies and description of the messianic kingdom in the book of **Zechariah**, which follows the remnant that returned from Babylon, we see this prophecy about a King riding into Jerusalem which we know was fulfilled by Jesus in **Mat 21**, **Mark 11**, **Luke 19**, and **John 12**.
- Notice that the LORD is speaking to the Lord (v9 “thy King” is the antecedent to the pronoun “thee” in v11).
- If we read v11 literally:
 - By the blood of Jesus I have sent forth His prisoners out of the dry hole in the ground.
 - Note that a pit can also be a place where water is drawn (as in **Isaiah 30:14**).
 - What prisoners? The children of Israel when they were in captivity? Where can we read about them being held prisoner in a dry hole in the ground? Where can we read in scripture anywhere about this happening?
 - There is very little evidence to support a literal interpretation. **Gen 37:24** (Joseph being cast into a pit with no water) and **Jer 38:6** (Jeremiah being cast into a dungeon wherein was no water) appear to be the closest references but neither one qualify because they were singular men and “thy prisoners” is plural.
- If we read v11 symbolically based on what we’ve learned:
 - By the blood of Jesus I have sent forth His prisoners out of hell wherein is no living water.
 - In **Psalms 63:1** David describes the wilderness of Judah as a “dry and thirsty land, where no water is”.
 - Not once are we told about David having any trouble finding food or water for him and the men with him aside from when David first fled to Nob and he requests the shewbread from Ahimelech in **1Sa 21:3**.
 - In **1Sa 25:18** (Abigail) and **2Sa 19:32** (Barzillai) we see the opposite.
 - There is a semi-colon at the end of **Psalms 63** verse 1 and David goes on to describe what exactly he’s been longing for and it’s *all* spiritual things.
 - In **John 4:10** Jesus offers “living water” to the Samaritan woman and in **John 4:14** He describes the living water. Living water comes from Jesus.
 - If living water symbolizes the Holy Ghost that lines up with what we’ve learned (**Acts 2:38, 10:45**).
 - In **John 7:38** Jesus tells us that “rivers of living water” shall flow out of the belly of he that believeth on Jesus. How many reborn Christians have you seen running around with literal rivers of water flowing out of their bellies? You haven’t and you won’t because He was talking about spiritual things.
- Regarding v11 past tense “have sent forth”
 - The verb Stem Piel (H8840) and the mood perfect (H8816) for this phrase does not necessitate that the *consequence* of the completed action happened in the past. For example, the *commandment* went forth (the completed action), and then the fulfillment of said commandment happens later.
 - Other examples of the commandment going forth before the manifestation of a thing:
 - **1Pe 1:20** – Jesus was ordained before the foundation of the world.
 - **Eph 1:4** – God *hath chosen* us (saints) before the foundation of the world.
 - **Eph 1:5** – *having predestinated us* (past tense, but includes anyone not saved yet)
 - **Gen 3:15, 12:1-3** (and many others) – Any of God’s promises. Since God cannot lie, it’s as good as done when He speaks it.

And so if we assemble the order of events from what we've learned we get:

1. Jesus dies on the cross at the ninth hour ([Mark 15:34](#), [Luke 23:44](#)).
 - God the Father transfers the authority over the gates of hell to Jesus.
2. Jesus unlocks the gates of hell.
3. Jesus' soul goes to hell.
4. Jesus preaches to the dead.
5. Those who accepted Jesus went to God in paradise ([Isaiah 49:9b](#)).
 - Including the penitent thief on the cross next to Jesus.
6. Those who rejected Jesus were left in the torment side of hell.
 - All before the end of the day that Jesus died on the cross.
 - Jesus gave up the ghost at the ninth hour leaving three hours left in that day ([John 11:9](#)).
7. When the evening of that first day was come (which is the beginning of the next day), Joseph of Arimathaea takes Jesus' body, wraps it in linen, and lays it in his own tomb ([Matthew 27:57-60](#)).
8. Two more Biblical days pass on earth.
9. Jesus is resurrected as the firstfruit of the dead, on the day of firstfruits and the first day of the week (the eighth day; the number eight representing new beginnings).
10. Some of the saints buried around Jerusalem are resurrected and go into Jerusalem *after* Jesus is resurrected.
11. 40 days later Jesus ascends bodily to heaven.
 - We don't know what happened to the resurrected saints after they went into Jerusalem and were seen of many.
 - They could have gone to heaven with Jesus.
 - They could have stayed and served God here.
 - They could have done and are doing both.